

There was the hint of a smile in the line of her mouth and cheeks, but was this the beginning of a broader grin or the end of one? Leonardo never said. Many later observers thought that Lisa was pregnant, which would explain the fullness of her chin and the looseness of her clothing. Again, there was no word from Leonardo about it. According to Vasari, Leonardo chose “to have men to sing and play to her and buffoons to amuse her, to take away that look of melancholy which is so often seen in portraits.”

Leonardo painting the *Mona Lisa*

